01 / TEST OVERVIEW

What is TOEFL?

TOEFL iBT

A computer-based English test used for university admissions. It measures how well you use English in academic and everyday situations.

Where you can take it

Take it at an authorised test centre or choose the Home Edition, which a live proctor supervises remotely.

BEFORE YOU BOOK

Check which test options your institution accepts, its minimum overall score and whether it asks for particular section scores.

TEST OPTIONS

05 / RESULTS & NEXT STEPS

Your score

You receive four section scores on a 1–6 scale. Your overall score is their average, rounded to the nearest half point.

TOEFL iBT SCORE	CEFR LEVEL
6	C2
5 or 5.5	C1
4 or 4.5	B2
3 or 3.5	B1
2 or 2.5	A2
1 or 1.5	A1

Scores are valid for two years. During the two-year transition from January 2026, reports also include a comparable overall score on the old 0–120 scale.

OFFICIAL ETS RESOURCES

Test format

Scores and CEFR levels

Practice materials

SCORES & PREPARATION

TEST TAKER'S GUIDE

TOEFL iBT

From 21 January 2026

What to expect in each section and how to read your score report.

R **Reading**

L **Listening**

W **Writing**

S **Speaking**

Four sections · Allow about 2 hours

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEST

02 / SECTIONS 1 & 2

Reading & Listening

Reading

ABOUT 30 MIN / 50 ITEMS

Complete words. Fill in missing letters in a short passage.

Read everyday texts. Answer questions about texts such as notices or messages.

Read an academic passage. Identify main ideas, details and implied meaning.

Listening

ABOUT 29 MIN / 47 ITEMS

Choose a suitable reply to a short recording. Answer questions about conversations, announcements and academic talks.

ADAPTIVE SECTIONS

Your performance in the first stage affects the difficulty of the next stage. Time and item counts can vary.

READING & LISTENING

03 / SECTION 3

Writing

ABOUT 23 MIN / 12 ITEMS

Use written English in three ways, from putting a sentence together to contributing to a class discussion.

BUILD A SENTENCE

Put words or phrases in order to make a reply that fits the conversation.

WRITE AN EMAIL

Write to someone in a given situation and address the points in the prompt.

Example Email a tutor to ask about joining a study group.

JOIN AN ACADEMIC DISCUSSION

Post your opinion and support it with reasons or examples.

Example Should universities record all lectures?

SENTENCES, EMAIL & DISCUSSION

04 / SECTION 4

Speaking

ABOUT 8 MIN / 11 ITEMS

Speak into a microphone. The computer records your responses to audio prompts.

LISTEN AND REPEAT

Listen to a sentence and repeat it as accurately and clearly as you can.

TAKE AN INTERVIEW

Answer questions from a recorded interviewer. Talk about your experiences or opinions and give reasons or examples.

Example Do you prefer studying alone or in a group? Explain why.

REPEAT & RESPOND